



INSTRUCTIONAL AREA

Pricing

RESTAURANT AND FOOD SERVICES MANAGEMENT SERIES EVENT

PARTICIPANT INSTRUCTIONS

(quoted directly from DECA, INC)

- "The event will be presented to you through your reading of the 21st Century Skills, Performance Indicators and Case Study Situation. You will have up to 30 minutes to review this information and prepare your presentation. You may make notes to use during your presentation."
- "You will have up to 15 minutes to make your presentation to the judge (you may have more than one judge)."
- "You will be evaluated on how well you meet the performance indicators of this event."
- "Turn in all of your notes and event materials when you have completed the event."

21st CENTURY SKILLS

- Critical Thinking – Reason effectively and use systems thinking.
- Communication – Communicate clearly.
- Creativity and Innovation – Show evidence of creativity.

PERFORMANCE INDICATORS

1. Explain the nature and scope of the pricing function.
2. Explain the concept of price in the hospitality and tourism industry.
3. Explain considerations in meal pricing.
4. Identify company's brand promise.
5. Determine factors affecting business risk.

EVENT SITUATION

You are to assume the role of the assistant general manager at HARBOR HAVEN BISTRO, a waterfront restaurant located in a popular coastal tourist town. The restaurant is known for its locally sourced seafood, seasonal dishes, and outdoor patio dining with a view of the marina. The menu prices range from \$18 to \$45, depending on the entrée. The bistro also offers Sunday brunch, takeout service, and a small selection of grab-and-go lunch options at a walk-up window.

During peak tourist months (late spring through early fall), HARBOR HAVEN BISTRO is packed every day, especially during dinner and weekend brunch hours. Wait times can exceed 90 minutes, and reservations are booked out days in advance. However, during the off-season (late fall and winter), business drops significantly—even on weekends—and the restaurant struggles to fill half the dining room.

The restaurant's owner (judge) wants to explore a seasonal pricing strategy to help smooth out sales throughout the year. They are considering raising prices slightly during the busy season and offering special pricing or bundled deals during the slower months to attract more locals and off-season travelers.

The owner (judge) has asked you to put together a pricing strategy that addresses the following:

- Clear price objectives for both peak and off-peak seasons
- Tactical adjustments to menu prices, including ideas for value-based specials, prix fixe menus, or bundled offers during slow times
- Considerations for regular customers and loyalty program members
- Marketing and communication strategies to explain seasonal pricing changes without creating customer frustration
- Potential benefits and risks of adopting this pricing model in a restaurant setting

You will present your ideas to the owner (judge) during a strategy meeting at the owner's office. The owner (judge) will begin the role-play by greeting you and asking to hear your proposal. After you present and answer any follow-up questions, the owner (judge) will conclude the role-play by thanking you for your suggestions.

Potential Judge's Questions:

1. How will you ensure that our local customers don't feel alienated by the seasonal price increases during peak tourist months?
2. What communication channels and messaging would you use to clearly explain seasonal pricing to customers without causing backlash?

Did the participant team:		Novice	Developing	Proficient	Exemplary	Judged Score
PERFORMANCE INDICATORS						
1.	Explain the nature and scope of the pricing function?	0-1-2-3	4-5-6-7	8-9	10	
2.	Explain the concept of price in the hospitality and tourism industry?	0-1-2-3	4-5-6-7	8-9	10	
3.	Explain considerations in meal pricing?	0-1-2-3	4-5-6-7	8-9	10	
4.	Identify company's brand promise?	0-1-2-3	4-5-6-7	8-9	10	
5.	Determine factors affecting business risk?	0-1-2-3	4-5-6-7	8-9	10	
SOLUTION						
6.	Unique– Demonstrates original thinking, fresh perspectives, and an insightful approach.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
7.	Practical– Actionable/viable in a real-world context.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
8.	Effective– Achieves relevant outcomes.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
CAREER COMPETENCIES						
9.	Critical Thinking– Thinks critically to understand and solve problems.	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
10.	Communication– Communicates clearly, effectively, and with reason.	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
11.	Decision-making– Considers the impacts of decisions.	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
OVERALL IMPRESSION						
12.	Overall impression– The degree to which the presentation leaves a lasting impression.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
TOTAL SCORE						